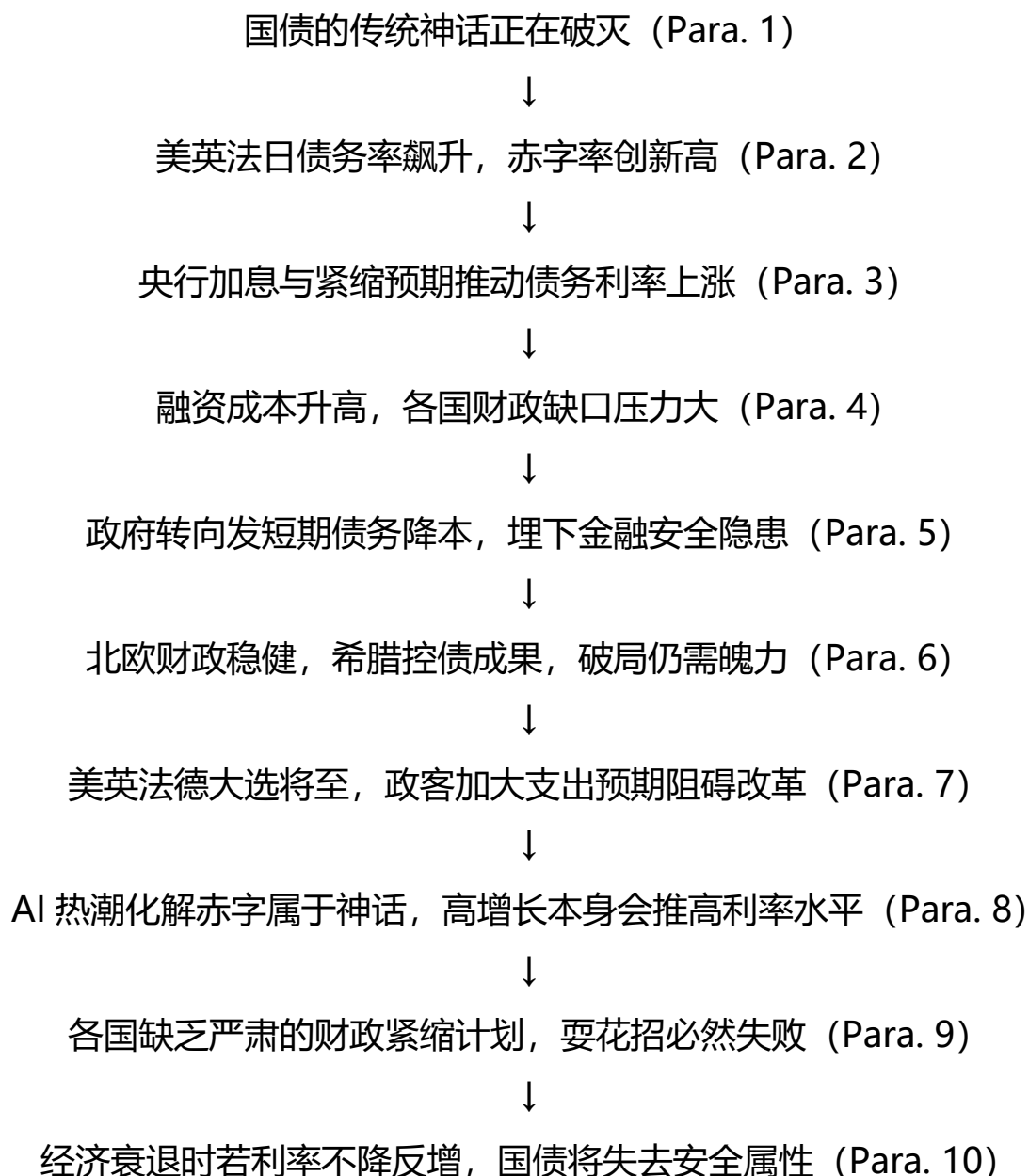


【9.27| Economist】Not your **bond** 时“贷”变了

难度评级：★★★★☆

【考研那些事儿之金融系列】

今日文章脉络：



Markets are waking up to the rich world's **reckless** borrowing

富裕国家鲁莽借贷引起市场警觉

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~】

【Para.1】

Finance does not offer many sure bets. One, for the past few decades, has been that most rich-world **sovereign bonds** are safe. Those lending cash to all but the **diciest** governments could feel confident they would get it back, plus **interest** at a rate set by a free market, and without the principal being inflated away. Bonds also helpfully **offset** the **volatility** of stocks by gaining value during **recessions**. Today, as public debts mount, all that is under threat.

- **bond** n. /bond/ an agreement by a government or a company to pay you interest on the money you have lent; a document containing this agreement 债券；公债【考研大纲词汇】

Government bonds are considered low-risk investments. 政府债券被认为是低风险投资。

n. a sum of money that is paid as bail 保释金

He was released on \$5 000 bond. 他以 5000 美元取保释放。

n. (formal) a legal written agreement or promise 书面的法律协定（或承诺）

We entered into a solemn bond. 我们缔结了一项严肃的协定。

- **reckless adj.** /'rekləs/ showing a lack of care about danger and the possible results of your actions 鲁莽的；不计后果的；无所顾忌的【考研大纲词汇】

He showed a reckless disregard for his own safety. 他对个人安危全然无所顾忌。

SYN careless, rash, thoughtless

- **sovereign bond n.** /'sɒvrɪn bɒnd/ a bond issued by a national government, generally with a promise to pay periodic interest payments and to repay the face value on the maturity date 主权债券；政府债券（由一国中央政府发行的债券）

Investors buy sovereign bonds to have stable, nearly risk-free investments. 投资者购买主权债券以获得稳定、几乎无风险的投资。

- **dicey adj.** /'daɪsi/ (**informal**) uncertain and dangerous 前途未卜的；冒险的；危险的

There was a dicey moment as one of our party made a risky climb up the cliff wall. 当我们一位队友在绝壁上进行冒险攀爬时，出现了危险的一刻。

- **interest n.** /'ɪnrəst/ (~ **on sth**) the extra money that you pay back when you borrow money or that you receive when you invest money 利息【考研大纲词汇】

The money was repaid with interest. 这笔钱是带息偿还的。

n. a good result or an advantage for sb/sth 好处；利益

She was acting entirely in her own interests. 她所做的完全是为了自己的好处。

n. (~ **in sth**) a connection with sth which affects your attitude to it, especially because you may benefit from it in some way 利害关系；利益关系

I should, at this point, declare my interest. 到了这个时候，我应该申明我的利益关系。

- **offset v.** /'ɒfset/ (~ **sth against sth**) to use one cost, payment or situation in order to cancel or reduce the effect of another 抵消；弥补；补偿【考研大纲词汇】

Prices have risen in order to offset the increased cost of materials. 为补偿原料成本的增加而提高了价格。

- **volatility** n. /ˌvɒləˈtɪləti/ the quality or state of being likely to change suddenly, especially by becoming worse 波动；波动性；剧烈变化

The economy is set to recover, despite recent stock market volatility. 尽管近期股市波动，经济仍有望复苏。

volatile adj. /ˈvɒlətaɪl/ likely to change suddenly; easily becoming dangerous 可能急剧波动的；不稳定的；易恶化的

Food and fuel prices are very volatile in a war situation. 战争时期食品和燃料的价格极易波动。

- **recession** n. /rɪˈseʃn/ a difficult time for the economy of a country, when there is less trade and industrial activity than usual and more people are unemployed 经济衰退；经济萎缩
【考研大纲词汇】

The country is sliding into the depths of (a) recession. 这个国家一步步滑入经济衰退的谷底。

金融市场上，真正十拿九稳的投资机会并不多。过去几十年来，可靠的投资倒有这么一桩，即大多数富裕国家发行的主权债券都是安全的。只要不是把钱借给那些最不靠谱的政府，债权人通常都可以放心，除了收回本金以外，还能在自由市场

的利率下拿到一份利息，也不会因通胀而影响实际购买力。而且在经济衰退时，债券往往会升值，从而抵消股票价格的波动。如今，随着各国公共债务攀升，这一切都受到了威胁。

【Para.2】

Since 2000 net government debt in America and Britain has tripled as a share of GDP. In France and Japan, it has doubled. The pile keeps growing: seldom outside wartime or recessions have rich-world **deficits** been higher than they are today.

- **deficit n.** /'defɪsɪt/ the amount by which money spent or owed is greater than money earned in a particular period of time 赤字；逆差；亏损【考研大纲词汇】

The trade balance has been in deficit for the past five years.
过去五年来贸易状况一直是逆差。

n. the amount by which sth, especially an amount of money, is too small or smaller than sth else 不足额；缺款额；缺少

There' s a deficit of \$3 million in the total needed to complete the project. 完成这项工程所需资金中有 300 万元的亏空。

自 2000 年以来，美国和英国的政府净债务占 GDP 的比重已经增加了两倍，达到原来的三倍；法国和日本则翻了一番。

而且，各国债务还在继续膨胀，除了战争时期或经济衰退期，富裕国家的财政赤字很少有像今天这样高的时候。

【Para.3】

In the 2010s, when borrowing was cheap, even big debts looked manageable. Today, **yields** are high and rising fast, most recently in response to the expectation that the war in Iran will **force up** interest rates. Sure enough on September 16th the Federal Reserve raised rates, becoming the fifth major rich-world central bank to do so this year. In expectation of **monetary tightening** to come, the ten-year Treasury yield has **exceeded** 5%, a **threshold** last crossed for any length of time two decades ago. The spreads on French bonds are not far off their levels during the European sovereign-debt crisis. After lying **dormant** for decades, yields are surging even in Japan. And the less said about Britain's **gilts**, the better.

- **yield n.** /ji:ld/ an amount of something positive, such as food or profit, that is produced or supplied 产生；出产；得出【考研大纲词汇】

Yields on gas and electricity shares are consistently high. 天然气与电力股票的收益一直很高

v. to supply or produce something positive such as a profit, an amount of food or information 产生；出产；得出

The investigation yielded some unexpected results. 调查得出了一些出乎意料的结果。

v. to give up the control of or responsibility for something, often because you have been forced to (常指被迫) 放弃, 让出

They were forced to yield (up) their land to the occupying forces. 他们被迫将领土割让给占领军。

- **force up** *phrasal verb* to make the price of something increase 使.....上升; 推高

The imposition of new vehicle safety features could force prices up by 25%. 强制实施新车辆安全功能可能会使价格上升25%。

SYN push up, drive up

- **monetary tightening** **n.** /'mʌnɪtri 'taɪtnɪŋ/ the policy in which a central bank raises interest rates and reserve requirements to make credit less accessible, aiming to reduce the money supply and control inflation 货币紧缩

The central bank's monetary tightening has made borrowing more expensive for businesses. 中央银行的货币紧缩政策使企业借贷成本更高。

- **exceed v.** /ɪk'si:d/ (formal) to be greater than a particular number or amount 超过 (数量) 【考研大纲词汇】

His achievements have exceeded expectations. 他的成就出乎预料。

- **threshold n.** /'θreʃhəʊld/ the level at which sth starts to happen or have an effect 阈；界；起始点 【考研大纲词汇】

He has a low boredom threshold. 他极易感到乏味。

- **dormant adj.** /'dɔ:mənt/ not active or growing now but able to become active or to grow in the future 休眠的；蛰伏的；暂停活动的 【考研大纲词汇】

These investments have remained dormant for several years. 这些投资好几年都没有什么动静。

- **gilt n.** /gɪlt/ (pl.) investments gilt-edged 金边证券；绩优证券

The return on indexed gilts might be used as one estimate of a longer-term real rate of interest. 指数化金边债券的回报可以用来估算较长期的实际利率。

21 世纪 10 年代，借贷成本低廉，即使是规模庞大的债务看起来也还在可控范围之内。如今，债券收益率已经处于高位，且仍在快速上升；最近一次上涨是因为市场预期伊朗战争将迫使利率进一步走高。果不其然，9 月 16 日，美联储上调了利率，

成为今年第五家加息的主要富裕国家央行。由于市场预期未来还会进一步收紧货币政策，美国 10 年期国债收益率已经突破 5%，而上一次突破这一门槛还是在 20 年前。法国国债与其他债券之间的利差，也已经非常接近欧洲主权债务危机时期的水平。日本债券收益率此前沉寂了数十年，如今甚至也在飙升。至于英国国债的表现，还是少谈为妙。

【Para.4】

In October 2025 The Economist calculated that if America and Britain had to immediately **refinance** all their debts at **prevailing** five-year bond yields, they would each need higher taxes or spending cuts worth 2.3% of GDP just to stop debt from rising as a share of the economy. Today, with yields higher, the number in America has more than doubled, to 4.7%. In Britain it has risen to 2.7% even though the government has tightened its belt. France's adjustment stands at 3.9% of GDP, up from 3.1% a year ago.

- **refinance v.** /ˌriːˈfaɪnæns/ to borrow money in order to pay a debt 再筹资金，再融资（以偿还债务）【考研大纲词汇】

A loan was arranged to refinance existing debt. 一笔贷款被安排来偿还已有的债务。

- **prevailing adj.** /prɪˈveɪlɪŋ/ existing or most common at a particular time 普遍的；盛行的；流行的【考研大纲词汇】

The prevailing view seems to be that they will find her guilty.

一般人的看法似乎认为她会被判有罪。

2025 年 10 月，本报经计算发现，如果美国和英国必须按照当时 5 年期的国债收益率，立即为全部债务进行再融资，那么为了仅仅阻止债务占经济总量的比重继续上升，两国都需要通过加税或削减支出，进行相当于 GDP 2.3% 的财政调整。如今，随着收益率进一步走高，美国所需的调整幅度已经翻了一倍多，达到 4.7%。英国则升至 2.7%，尽管其政府已经收紧财政支出。法国所需的财政调整水平约为 3.9%，高于一年前的 3.1%。

【Para.5】

Fortunately, in the real world governments need not refinance everything all at once. However, they have been shifting towards shorter-term debt, meaning that higher interest rates feed through to budgets more quickly than they did. Issuing short is **alluring** because it is usually cheaper. There is also less demand for long-term debt these days, because the defined-benefit **pension** funds that have long hungered for it are shrinking. But short-term debt and a volatile bond market make for an **inflammable** mix.

- **alluring** adj. /ə'luəriŋ/ attractive and exciting in a mysterious way 诱人的；迷人的；有吸引力的

I didn' t find the prospect of a house with no electricity very alluring. 我无法想象，一幢连电都没有接通的房子会有什么吸引力。

- **pension n.** /'penʃn/ an amount of money paid regularly by a government or company to sb who is considered to be too old or too ill/sick to work 养老金；退休金；抚恤金【考研大纲词汇】

He won' t be able to draw his pension until he' s 65. 他得等到 65 岁以后才能领取养老金。

- **flammable adj.** /ɪn'flæməbl/ that can burn easily 易燃的；可燃的【考研大纲词汇】

These gases are highly inflammable. 这些气体都高度易燃。

adj. full of strong emotions or violence 易激动的；易激怒的

an inflammable situation/region 一触即发的局势/地区

幸运的是，政府在现实情况下并不需要一次性为所有债务进行再融资。不过，各国近年来一直在转向发行期限更短的债务，这意味着与过去相比，较高的利率会加快传导至政府预算。发行短期债务之所以诱人，是因为它通常成本更低。此外，如今市场对长期债务的需求也有所下降，因为长期以来一直热衷于持有长期债券的确定收益型养老金基金正在逐渐萎缩。但短

期债务与剧烈波动的债券市场结合起来，可谓是易燃易爆的危险组合。

【Para.6】

It is not yet too late to solve the problem. Like other rich countries, Switzerland has an ageing population. But it is in fine **fiscal** fettle, with low debt, little **inflation** and bond yields that have correspondingly stayed low. **Motivated** governments have cut big deficits before. Sweden **vanquished** 11% deficits in the 1990s, **splitting** the job between spending cuts, tax rises and supply-side **reforms** to boost growth. “Be Swiss or Scandi” may not be realistic advice, but even “Be Greek” would do. Greece has pulled debt-to-GDP down sharply. This summer it issued bonds with lower yields than France’s.

- **fiscal adj.** /'fɪskl/ connected with government or public money, especially taxes 财政的；国库的；税收的【考研大纲词汇】

The government announced a series of fiscal measures to stimulate the economy. 政府宣布了一系列财政措施以刺激经济。

- **inflation n.** /ɪn'fleɪʃn/ a general rise in the prices of services and goods in a particular country, resulting in a fall in the

value of money; the rate at which this happens 通货膨胀;

通胀率【考研大纲词汇】

Wage increases must be in line with inflation. 工资的增长必须与通货膨胀率一致。

deflation n. /,di:'fleɪn/ a reduction in the amount of money in a country's economy so that prices fall or remain the same 通货紧缩

Deflation is beginning to take hold in the clothing industry. 服装业开始出现通货紧缩。

- **motivated** adj. /'məʊtɪveɪtɪd/ very enthusiastic or determined because you really want to do something 有积极性的【考研大纲词汇】

She is highly motivated and works hard at everything she does. 她非常积极，做任何事都很努力。

- **vanquish** v. /'væŋkwɪʃ/ to defeat an enemy or opponent, especially in war (尤指战争中) 击败，使溃败【考研大纲词汇】

The vanquished army surrendered their weapons. 战败的军队交出了他们的武器。

- **split** v. /splɪt/ (~ sth between sb/sth) (~ sth with sb) to divide sth into two or more parts and share it between

different people, activities, etc. 分担；分摊；分享【考研大纲词汇】

His time is split between the London and Paris offices. 他一半时间在伦敦的办事处，一半时间在巴黎的办事处。

- **reform n.** /rɪ'fɔ:m/ change that is made to a social system, an organization, etc. in order to improve or correct it 改革；变革；改良；改善【考研大纲词汇】

Some reforms of/to the system will be necessary. 有必要对该制度进行一些改革。

v. to improve a system, an organization, a law, etc. by making changes to it 改革；改进；改良

The Bill will reform the tax system. 该法案将改革税收制度。

v. to improve your behaviour; to make sb do this (使) 改正，改造（行为）；（使）悔改

She thought she could reform him. 她觉得她可以使他洗心革面。

亡羊补牢，未为晚也。和其他富裕国家一样，瑞士也面临人口老龄化。但它的财政状况十分稳健：债务水平低、通胀温和，债券收益率也相应地一直维持在较低水平。历史上，也有不少政府励精图治，成功削减巨额财政赤字。上世纪 90 年代，瑞典多措并举，通过削减支出、提高税收以及推动供给侧改革

以促进经济增长，消除了 11% 的财政赤字率。“向瑞士或北欧国家看齐”也许并不现实，但即便是“学希腊”也未尝不可。希腊已经大幅降低了其 GDP 中的债务占比。今年夏天，希腊发行债券时的收益率已经低于法国的水平。

在 20 世纪 90 年代初，瑞典爆发了严重的房地产与银行业金融危机，导致经济陷入深重衰退，连续三年 GDP 出现负增长。当时，由于税收锐减、失业救济与银行救助等公共支出激增，瑞典的财政状况急剧恶化。1993 年，瑞典公共财政赤字占 GDP 的比重飙升至 11% 左右（部分官方统计或研究数据甚至认为高达 12%）。瑞典在 1994 年底新政府上台后，推行了极为严厉且系统的财政重组计划。到 1998 年左右，瑞典就成功消除了财政赤字，实现了预算平衡。

【Para.7】

The trouble is that the next few years' politics are **perilous**. In France big-spending **populists** are looking strong ahead of a presidential election in 2027. In America, which elects a new president in 2028, Democrats and Republicans are **vying** to promise ever-bigger cheques (literally, in the case of the \$5,000 payouts Donald Trump proposed as a reward if Republicans win Congress in the midterms). Britain and Germany, each with its own fiscally **lax** populists, go to the polls in 2029.

- **perilous adj.** /'perələs/ (formal literary) very dangerous 危险的；艰险的【考研大纲词汇】

With the outbreak of war, crossing the road became newly perilous. 战争爆发后，过马路都变得危险起来。

peril n. /'perəl/ (formal literary) serious danger 严重危险

The country's economy is now in grave peril. 现在，这个国家的经济陷入了严重危机。

- **populist n.** /'pɒpjəlɪst/ someone who expresses populist views 平民主义者；民粹主义者

In appealing to the masses of poor people prior to gaining power, populists may promise widely-demanded food, housing, employment, basic social services, and income redistribution. 在获得权力之前，民粹主义者为了吸引大量穷人，可能会承诺提供广泛需求的食物、住房、就业、基本社会服务和收入再分配。

- **vie v.** /vaɪ/ (~ with sb) (for sth) (formal) (vying vied vied/'vaɪɪŋ/) to compete strongly with sb in order to obtain or achieve sth 激烈竞争；争夺【考研大纲词汇】

Screaming fans vied to get closer to their idol. 尖声喊叫的崇拜者争先恐后地涌向他们的偶像。

- **lax adj.** /læks/ not strict, severe or careful enough about work, rules or standards of behaviour 不严格的；不严厉的；马虎的【考研大纲词汇】

One of the problem areas is lax security for airport personnel. 其中一个问题是对机场人员的安全措施不严格。

SYN slack careless

问题在于，未来几年的政治局势充满风险。法国即将在 2027 年举行总统选举，而主张大规模增加政府支出的民粹主义政治力量目前势头强劲。美国将在 2028 年选出新总统，民主党和共和党都在争相承诺更大额度的支票（唐纳德·特朗普（Donald Trump）提出的方案甚至是字面意义上的支票，即如果共和党在中期选举中赢得国会，就向民众发放面额 5000 美元作为回报）。英国和德国则各自面临财政立场宽松的民粹主义政治力量，并将于 2029 年举行选举。

【Para.8】

Politicians may well hope that surging growth from an artificial-intelligence boom will **miraculously** rescue them from painful budget negotiations. South Korea's government **projects** that taxes from chipmaking **proceeds** will all but eliminate its budget deficit next year. But the productivity growth required to **tame** deficits is well above what most economists see as **plausible**, and in any case higher growth also raises

interest rates.

- **miraculously adv.** /mɪ'rækjələsli/ in a way that is very surprising or difficult to believe 奇迹般地

Miraculously, all 25 crewmen aboard the eight planes survived their icy landings. 八架飞机上的二十五名机组成员在冰面着陆中全部都奇迹般地生还了。

- **project v.** /prə'dʒekt/ (usually passive) to estimate what the size, cost or amount of sth will be in the future based on what is happening now 预测；预计；推想【考研大纲词汇】

The unemployment rate has been projected to fall. 据预测失业率将下降。

- **proceeds n.** /'prəʊsi:dz/ (~ of/from sth) the money that you receive when you sell sth or organize a performance, etc.; profits (售物或演出等的) 收入，收益，进款 (注意重音)

She sold her car and bought a piano with the proceeds. 她卖掉了汽车，然后用这笔收入买了一架钢琴。

- **tame v.** /teɪm/ to make sth tame or easy to control 驯化；驯服；使易于控制

She made strenuous efforts to tame her anger. 她竭力压制心头怒火。

- **plausible adj.** /'plɔ:zəbl/ seeming likely to be true, or able to be believed 貌似真实（或可信）的【考研大纲词汇】

Her story sounded perfectly plausible. 她的说辞听起来言之有理。

政客们或许希望，人工智能热潮带来的经济高速增长能够带来奇迹，将他们从痛苦的财政预算谈判中解救出来。韩国政府预计，明年芯片制造业带来的税收收入将几乎完全消除其财政赤字。然而，要真正遏制财政赤字，所需要的生产力增速远远高于大多数经济学家认为合理的水平；而且无论在何种情况下，更快的经济增长也会推高利率。

【Para.9】

What happens next? Among big **debtors** only Britain, which faced a market **revolt** after Liz Truss's disastrous mini-budget in 2022, has a (semi-serious) plan to tighten. Expect more Truss-like moments elsewhere. Wise governments will respond with sounder budgeting; **louche** ones with financial **shenanigans**. Scott Bessent, America's treasury secretary, began directly **intervening** in the Treasury market in August in a **futile** attempt to **suppress** yields.

- **debtor n.** /'detə(r)/ a person, a country or an organization that owes money 债务人；借方【考研大纲词汇】

The company is one of the country's largest debtors. 该公司是该国最大的债务人之一。

creditor n. /'kreditə(r)/ a person, company, etc. that sb owes money to 债权人；债主；贷方

The company couldn't pay its creditors. 该公司无力向债权人偿债。

- **revolt n.** /rɪ'veʊlt/ an attempt to get rid of a government by using violence 反抗；造反；反叛【考研大纲词汇】

Troops were called in to crush/put down the revolt. 军队被调来镇压叛乱。

- **louche adj.** /luːʃ/ (especially BrE formal) not socially acceptable, but often still attractive despite this 声名不好却有吸引力的（注意发音）

He was a louche character who frequented the city's most exclusive nightclubs. 他是个名声不太好但颇具魅力的角色，经常出入城里最高档的夜总会。

- **shenanigan n.** /ʃɪ'næɪɪgən/ secret or dishonest activities, usually of a complicated type 诡计；欺诈；耍手腕；欺骗行为

There was some kind of shenanigan going on at the election. 选举中发生了一些欺诈行为。

- **intervene v.** /,ɪntə'veɪn/ (~ in sth) to become involved in a situation in order to improve or help it 出面；介入【考研大纲词汇】

The Central Bank intervened in the currency markets to stabilize the exchange rate. 中央银行干预货币市场以稳定汇率。

前缀：inter-在...之间，相互

interrupt v. /,ɪntə'rʌpt/ 打断 (inter- 在...之间，相互 + rupt 打破，破裂)

interfere vt. /,ɪntə'fɪə(r)/ 干涉 (inter- 在...之间，相互 + fere 带来，拿来)

internal adj. /ɪn'tɜ:n(ə)l/ 里面的 (inter- 在...之间，相互 + -al ...的)

- **futile adj.** /'fju:taɪl/ having no purpose because there is no chance of success 徒然的；徒劳的；无效的【考研大纲词汇】

Their efforts to revive him were futile. 他们抢救他的努力都是徒劳的。

- **suppress v.** /sə'pres/ to prevent sth from growing, developing or continuing 压制；阻止；抑制【考研大纲词汇】

His feelings of resentment have been suppressed for years. 他的怨恨之情已经压抑了多年。

v. to end something by force (用武力) 镇压, 压制, 制止

The Hungarian uprising in 1956 was suppressed by the Soviet Union. 1956 年匈牙利起义被苏联武力镇压。

接下来会发生什么？在主要债务国中，只有英国有一项（勉强算得上认真的）财政紧缩计划。因为在 2022 年，时任英国首相利兹·特拉斯（Liz Truss）的“迷你预算”就曾引发市场的强烈反应，堪称一场灾难。预计其他国家也会出现更多特拉斯式的市场震荡。明智的政府会以更加稳健的预算管理应对；不那么正派的政府，则可能玩弄一些金融手段。美国财政部长斯科特·贝森特（Scott Bessent）8 月开始直接干预美国国债市场，试图压低债券收益率，但最终只是徒劳一场。

2022 年 9 月 23 日，时任财政大臣夸西·克沃滕代表特拉斯政府公布“迷你预算”，其中包括大规模减税等措施。市场认为政府的财政计划缺乏可信的融资安排，投资者通过抛售英国国债、推高国债收益率和抛售英镑等方式，对政府的财政政策投下“不信任票”，迅速作出负面反应。当时英国国债市场出现了极端波动、单边抛售压力以及市场功能迅速恶化。10 月 3 日至 17 日期间，英国财政部门陆续撤销关键的“迷你预算”措施，市场随后对恢复财政纪律的信号作出了明显积极反应。

【Para.10】

In a recession, more serious trouble could come. It is not **inevitable**

that bond yields fall in **downturns**. That often fails to happen in emerging markets; and it didn't in the rich world during the 1970s. Even a smaller-than-usual decline in yields would worsen the economic pain and **compound** the hit to budgets from higher unemployment. Bond markets, once **havens**, will have become danger zones.

- **inevitable adj.** /ɪn'evɪtəbl/ that you cannot avoid or prevent
不可避免的；不能防止的【考研大纲词汇】

It was inevitable that there would be job losses. 裁员已是不可避免的事。

SYN unavoidable

adj. so frequent that you always expect it 总会发生的；照例必有的；惯常的

the English and their inevitable cups of tea 英国人和他们那必不可少的茶

- **downturn n.** /'daʊntɜ:n/ (~ in sth) a fall in the amount of business that is done; a time when the economy becomes weaker (商业经济的) 衰退，下降，衰退期【考研大纲词汇】

The building industry is experiencing a severe downturn in its fortunes. 建筑业正经历命运的大逆转。

- **compound v.** /kəm'paʊnd/ to make sth bad become even worse by causing further damage or problems 使加重；使恶化【考研大纲词汇】

The problems were compounded by severe food shortages.
严重的食物短缺使问题进一步恶化。

- **haven n.** /'heɪvn/ a place that is safe and peaceful where people or animals are protected 安全的地方；保护区；避难所【考研大纲词汇】

The garden was a haven from the noise and bustle of the city. 这个花园是块远离喧嚣都市的静地。

如果经济陷入衰退，更严重的麻烦可能随之而来。经济下行时债券收益率下降的规律并不一定成立。新兴市场在经济低迷时，债券收益率经常不会下降；20 世纪 70 年代的富裕国家也没有出现过类似情况。即使收益率的降幅低于通常水平，也会加剧经济痛苦，并进一步加重失业率上升给财政预算带来的冲击。届时，那些曾被视为避风港的债券市场将变成危险地带。

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➤ **今日翻译作业**

(Para. 4) In October 2025 The Economist calculated that if America and Britain had to immediately refinance all their debts at prevailing five-year bond yields, they would each need higher taxes or spending cuts worth 2.3% of GDP just to stop debt from rising as a share of the economy. (下一页提供句子分析)

➤ 今日句子分析

Para. 4 In October 2025 The Economist calculated that if America and Britain had to immediately refinance all their debts at prevailing five-year bond yields, they would each need higher taxes or spending cuts worth 2.3% of GDP just to stop debt from rising as a share of the economy. 2025 年 10 月，本报经计算发现，如果美国和英国必须按照当时 5 年期的国债收益率，立即为全部债务进行再融资，那么为了仅仅阻止债务占经济总量的比重继续上升，两国都需要通过加税或削减支出，进行相当于 GDP 2.3% 的财政调整。

主句

In October 2025

时间状语

The Economist

主语

calculated

谓语

宾语从句

that

条件状语从句

if

America and Britain

主语

had to

immediately

时间状语

refinance

谓语

all their debts

宾语

at prevailing five-year bond yields,

水平/程度状语

they

would

each

need

主语	方式状语	谓语
higher taxes or spending cuts		worth 2.3% of GDP
宾语		后置定语
just to stop debt	from rising	
目的状语	宾语补足语	
as a share of the economy.		
方式状语		

主句：

时间状语：In October 2025；主语：The Economist；谓语：calculated；

宾语从句：

引导词：that；

条件状语从句：

连词：if；主语：America and Britain；时间状语：had to immediately；谓语：refinance；

宾语：all their debts；（their 和后文的 they 都指 America and Britain。）水平/程度状语：at prevailing five-year bond yields；

主语：they；方式状语：would need；谓语：each；（注意把 each 翻译为“都”，不要丢失原文强调的意味。）

宾语：higher taxes or spending cuts；后置定语：worth 2.3% of GDP；

(主句和从句都是一般过去时，但这句条件状语从句不能简单理解为这一时态。if 在这里是做假设，与现在或未来事实相反或可能性较低的假设，而不是真的指过去的时间。例如 If I had more money, I would buy a car. 虽然形式上是过去式，但并不是假设过去有更多钱，而是现在有更多钱。同理，本文例句也是 if ... have to do..., they will ... 使用过去式变成虚拟语气。

原文没有直接出现 through / by means of, 而译文增译“通过”，即政府通过某种手段达到某种目的，把原文隐含的明确表达出来。

worth 2.3% of GDP 修饰前文整个名词短语 higher taxes or spending cuts, 即：提高税收或削减支出，无论采取哪一种方式，所需要的财政调整规模都相当于 GDP 的 2.3%。)

目的状语：just to stop debt; (just 在这里是带有讽刺意味的：2.3% 的财政调整，只是为了让债务占 GDP 的比例不再继续恶化。因此要翻译出“仅仅”，否则会影响原文的情感态度。) 宾语补足语：from rising;

方式状语：as a share of the economy; (整个 just to stop...of the economy 部分都是目的状语，其中包含宾补和方式状语。)

➤ 写作积累

1. (Para. 4) In Britain it has risen to 2.7% even though the government has **tightened its belt**.

tighten its belt 表示 “to spend less money and live more frugally because you have less income or face financial hardship” , 即 “减少开支、节衣缩食、勒紧裤腰带” , 例如, With profits falling, the corporation is tightening its belt and freezing all new hiring. 随着利润下滑, 这家大企业正在紧缩开支, 并冻结了所有新员工的招聘。此外, 还有以下表达可以表示相同的含义:

- ♦ **cut back on spending** *idiom* to decrease the amount of money you pay out or reduce your overall financial expenses 削减开支

Consumers cut back on spending / cut back on spending when a recession impacts the economy. 在经济担忧或衰退时, 消费者往往会减少消费与缩减开支。

- ♦ **make economies** *phrase* to save money by spending less or cutting down on unnecessary expenses 削减开支; 节约; 节省; 精打细算

The company had to make economies by cutting its marketing budget. 公司不得不通过削减营销预算来紧缩开支。

2. (Para. 5) However, they have been shifting towards shorter-term debt, meaning that higher interest rates **feed through to** budgets more quickly than they did.

feed through to 表示 “to have a gradual, noticeable effect on a later stage of a process, or to pass a cost, change, or signal down a chain to a final outcome” , 即 “逐渐影响到、渗透到、传导至” , 例如, It will take time for the higher rates to feed through to investors. 较高的利率需要一段时间才能传导至投资者。此外, 还有以下表达可以在写作时选用:

- ♦ **translate into** *phrasal verb* to lead to or turn out as a specific consequence or value 转化为, 最终体现为
Higher interest rates will translate into higher debt-servicing costs. 更高的利率最终会转化为更高的债务偿付成本。
- ♦ **work its way through/to** *idiom* to progress, move, or process something gradually, steadily 慢慢行进到、逐渐达到某处, 逐步推进并到达某个地方或目标
The new tax reform bill is slowly working its way through Congress. 这项新的税制改革法案正在国会中艰难而缓慢地推进/审议